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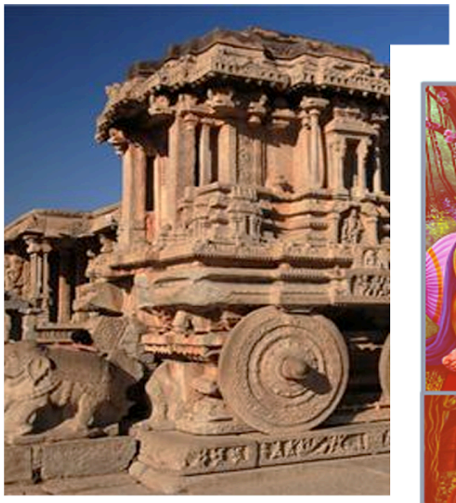
General Knowledge
Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

BABUR (1526-1530 A.D.)



BABUR (1526-1530 A.D.)

Introduction

- Babur, born **Zahiruddin Muhammad,** was the **founder of the Mughal Empire in India**.
- On February 14, 1483, Babur was born into the Timurid royal family in Andijan, Uzbekistan.
- His mother, **Qutlaq Nigar Khanum**, was a **Moghul King Yunus Khan's daughte**r, while his father, **Umar Sheikh Mirza**, was the Emir of Ferghana.
- He was a descendant of Timur and Genghis Khan.
- When the Emir of Ferghana unexpectedly passed away in **1494, 11-year-old Babur took the throne.**
- Babar had to deal with a great deal of hostility from the aristocracy itself since the situation in Central Asia was not stable.
- Even though he successfully took Samarqand, he soon had to retreat due to some of his nobles deserting.
- Farghana was also lost to the Uzbeks. He took **control of Kabul in 1504** after years of wandering.
- He had planned to move toward Hindustan during the entire time.
- Finally, he started making bold strides in the direction of **India starting in 1517**.

Advent to India

- Conflict erupted between several **Afghan leaders and Ibrahim Lodi in India in the 1517s** and **Daulat Khan Lodi**, the governor of Punjab, stood out among them.
- Rana Sanga, the Rajput monarch of Mewar, attempted to expand his sphere of influence in north India and reassert his control over Ibrahim Lodi.
- They both informed Babur to conquer India. Babur encroached on **Bhera, Sialkot, and Lahore between 1519 and 1524**.

First Battle of Panipat

- At Panipat, Ibrahim Lodi and **Babur faced each other on 21 April, 1526.**
- Babur's forces, though smaller, were well-equipped with matchlock guns and artillery. His troops were seasoned veterans of Central Asian campaigns, and he carefully selected the battlefield to avoid encirclement.
- Babur used the Ottoman (Rumi) strategy of linking carts, inspired by the Battle of Chaldiran (1514). He added an innovation by leaving gaps wide enough to allow 50–100 horses to charge through, enhancing mobility.
- Ibrahim Lodi commanded a larger force but lacked modern artillery and an effective command structure. His reliance on traditional cavalry and elephants was no match for Babur's strategic and technological superiority.
- The First Battle of Panipat marked the destruction of Lodi's army and established the foundation of the Mughal Empire in India.
- For Babur, this victory concluded the second phase of his conquest of Northern India. While he gained control over Delhi and Agra, his real challenges began after Panipat to consolidate his rule.
- This battle is a turning point in medieval Indian history, signifying the end of the Delhi Sultanate and the beginning of Mughal dominance.

Battle of Khanwa

- Despite extending an invitation to Babur to visit India, **Rana Sanga organized a union of Rajput** princes to fight the invader after he realized Babur had decided to stay. **On March 16, 1527, Babur and Rana Sanga engaged in the Battle at Khanwa.**
- Rana Sanga wished to depose Babur because he saw him as an outsider in charge of India.

- At the **Battle of Khanwa at Fatehpur Sikri in AD 1527,** Babur and Rana Sanga met. Babur's superior weaponry and strategy allowed him to beat Rana Sanga.
- Because it firmly established the Mughal empire in India, the Battle of Khanwa was a more decisive Battle than the Battle of Panipat.
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Battle of Chanderi

- The Battle of Khanwa was followed by the Battle of Chanderi. Babur decided to **isolate Rana by overthrowing Medini Rai,** the ruler of Malwa, after learning that Rana Sanga had started making plans to resume the fight with him.
- Medini Rai was one of Rana's most steadfast allies.
- **On January 20, 1528,** after reaching Chanderi, Babur made a peace approach by offering Shamsabad to Medini Rao in exchange for Chanderi. However, the offer was turned down.
- Medini Rai planned a Jauhar after realizing there was no chance of success.
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Battle of Ghaghra

- In the **Battle of Ghagra in AD 1529,** Babur defeated the Afghans on the banks of the river Ghagra after defeating the Rajputs.
- Babur's power consequently encompassed nearly all of northern India, including Kabul, Agra, Awadh, Gwalior, Bihar, and portions of Rajasthan and Punjab, Agra, Awadh, and Awadh.
- **Babur established Delhi as the Mughal Empire's capital.**

Overview of the Babur Battle

Battle	Opponent	Date	Place	Outcome
Battle of Panipat	Ibrahim Lodi (Sultan of Delhi)	21 April 1526	Panipat, Haryana	Babur defeated Ibrahim Lodi, leading to the foundation of the Mughal Empire in India.
Battle of Khanwa	Rana Sanga	17 March 1527	Khanwa, near	Babur defeated the

	(Rajput King)		Fatehpur Sikri	Rajput forces, consolidating Mughal rule in North India.
Battle of Chanderi	Medini Rai (Rajput Chief)	29 January 1528	Chanderi, Madhya Pradesh	Babur captured Chanderi, defeating the Rajput defenders
Battle of Ghaghra	Mahmud Lodi (Afghan Chief) & Eastern Afghan Confederacy	6 May 1529	Ghaghra River, Bihar	Babur defeated the Afghan forces, further securing his control over North India.

Autobiography of Babur

Book Title	Author	Language	Description
Baburnama	Babur	Chagatai Turkish (later translated into Persian, English, etc.)	Autobiography of Babur, detailing his life, conquests, thoughts, and observations. It is one of the first autobiographies in Islamic literature.

Architectural contributions and structures associated With Babur

Structure/ Monument	Location	Type	Architectural Features	Remarks
Babri Masjid	Ayodhya,	Mosque	Simple design,	Disputed site; believed to

	Uttar Pradesh		Islamic architecture, large domes, and minarets.	have been built by Babur in 1528.
Aram Bagh (Garden of Rest)	Agra, Uttar Pradesh	Garden (Charbagh)	Charbagh layout (four-part garden), Persian influence, canals, and water features.	One of the earliest Mughal gardens in India.
Bagh-e-Babur	Kabul, Afghanistan	Garden (Charbagh)	Symmetrical design, Persian style, terraces, and water channels.	Babur's tomb is located here; in his favorite garden.
Ram Bagh	Agra, Uttar Pradesh	Garden (Charbagh)	Charbagh layout, terraced gardens, central water channels, pavilions.	Initially designed as a resting place for Babur.
Dholpur Palace	Dholpur, Rajasthan	Palace.	Red sandstone, simple Mughal architecture, arches, and courtyards.	Associated with Babur's reign, though heavily altered later.

Death of Babur

- Babur was not given enough time to live to see the benefits of his conquests.
- **In AD 1530**, four years following the Battle of Panipat, Babur passed away.
- **On December 26, 1530, Babur died in Agra at 47**. His eldest son, Humayun, succeeded him.
- His lifeless remains were initially interred in Agra, but, following his intentions, they were later transported to Kabul and reinterred in **Bagh-e Babur sometime between 1539 and 1544.**

- Babur was a fantastic poet and writer and is renowned as the man who established the Mughal Empire.
- His biography, the **Baburnama in Persian and the Tuzki-Baburi in Turki** provide details about his life, circumstances, and way of life during the period. He had the power to win his people's affection and respect.